Pepperoni Garlic Knots

Breads | Oven

Before you start

Makes: 24 knots. Equipment: 10-inch cast-iron skillet. Rise: until doubled, about 4 hours at room temperature or 12-16 hours refrigerated. Oven: 425°F. Bake: 25-30 minutes.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Garlic and red pepper

Bowl B - Fresh herbs

- [ ] 2 Tbsp unsalted butter
- [ ] 2 Tbsp extra-virgin olive oil, plus more for finishing
- [ ] 4 oz pepperoni, cut small
- [ ] Pinch red pepper flakes [Bowl A]
- [ ] 6 garlic cloves, minced [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/4 cup chopped parsley [Bowl B]
- [ ] 2 Tbsp minced chives, optional [Bowl B]
- [ ] 1/2 cup grated Parmesan, plus more for finishing
- [ ] Flour for dusting
- [ ] 1 lb pizza dough
- [ ] 1/4 cup grated Pecorino Romano
- [ ] Pizza sauce, for serving

1. Make pepperoni-garlic coating

1. Melt 2 Tbsp unsalted butter with 2 Tbsp extra-virgin olive oil in a 10-inch cast-iron skillet.

2. Add 4 oz pepperoni, cut small, and cook about 2 minutes, until crisp. Add a pinch of red pepper flakes and 6 minced garlic cloves; cook about 1 minute.

3. Stir in 1/4 cup chopped parsley and optional 2 Tbsp minced chives. Transfer to a bowl and mix in 1/2 cup grated Parmesan.

2. Shape and rise

1. Using flour for dusting, divide 1 lb pizza dough into two halves. Stretch each half into roughly an 8×4-inch rectangle and cut each into 12 strips.

2. Tie the 24 strips into knots. Toss thoroughly with the prepared pepperoni-garlic coating and arrange in the skillet.

3. Drizzle lightly with additional olive oil, cover, and let rise until doubled: about 4 hours at room temperature or 12-16 hours refrigerated.

3. Bake and serve

1. Heat the oven to 425°F. Sprinkle knots with 1/4 cup grated Pecorino Romano.
2. Bake 25-30 minutes, until golden and crisp.
3. Brush hot knots with additional olive oil, sprinkle with extra Parmesan, and serve with warm pizza sauce.